



CHINA · FEATURED DEPARTURES

Kiwi journeys to China 2026 → 2027

Four confirmed small-group departures across late 2026 and March 2027. NZ-only groups. Fully inclusive. Priced from NZ\$4,080pp.

EST. AUCKLAND 2000 · CTS GROUP FOUNDED 1928

CTSTOURS.CO.NZ

The Kiwi China specialist.

CTS Tours New Zealand was established in Auckland in 2000 by Lisa Li (MNZM) — the New Zealand arm of the China Travel Service Group, founded in 1928. Twenty-five years on we look after more than a thousand Kiwi travellers to China every year, with NZ-only small groups, on-the-ground offices across China, and pricing that includes the things others quietly leave out.

1928

Global heritage — CTS parent network directly operating in China since 1928

25

Years in Auckland — Kiwi-owned local operations since 2000

12–20

Typical group size — expert local guides in every city

4.4★

Verified Google reviews from real Kiwi travellers



★ ★ ★ ★ ★ from verified Kiwi travellers

"Two of the world's great historical capitals in ten days. Couldn't have asked for more."

— Claire & Tom Mackenzie

"Two weeks in Yunnan and barely another Western tourist in sight — sweet as trip from start to finish."

— Liz & Peter Armstrong

Welcome — let me plan your **China trip.**



I've spent over **20 years designing premium China tours** — from Beijing's Forbidden City and Shanghai's Bund to the rural villages of Yunnan and the ancient Silk Road. Every tour in this catalogue I've personally helped shape and travelled myself.

When you call CTS, you'll speak to a real China specialist — most likely me. No call centres, no overseas hand-off. Just honest advice from someone who's spent two decades designing China trips for Kiwi travellers.

Want help choosing? Give me a call on **0800 287 888** — I'll give you a no-pressure recommendation based on your dates, pace, and what you most want to see.

YOUR CHINA
SPECIALIST

Baker Gu

China Travel Specialist · 20+
years

CALL

0800 CTS 888

0800 287 888

EMAIL

info@ctstours.co.nz

Same-day reply Mon–Fri

VISIT

**2F CTS House
175 Queen Street**

Auckland CBD

ONLINE

ctstours.co.nz

24/7 enquiry form

The window is open.

For the first time in living memory, New Zealand passport holders can walk straight through Chinese immigration — no visa, no forms, no queues at the embassy. The policy runs through **31 December 2026**, and CTS's small groups depart into the shoulder seasons Kiwis actually enjoy travelling in.



CURRENT POLICY

30-day visa-free entry for NZ passport holders

WHAT'S COVERED

Tourism, business, family visits and transit. Unlimited entries. No application forms needed.

WHERE YOU CAN ENTER

All the major hubs — Beijing, Shanghai, Guangzhou, Xi'an and Chengdu — process NZ passports directly through visa-free immigration.

WHAT TO BRING

NZ passport with blank pages, return flight, and proof of accommodation (your CTS tour confirmation is enough).

BEST TIME TO TRAVEL → Autumn (September–October) and spring (April–May) both give you cool, clear days across northern China. November stays crisp and quiet; late March is when Hangzhou's West Lake starts to bloom.

Five cities, five Chinas.

Every CTS itinerary weaves together several very different Chinas. Here's how to think about the ones you'll actually walk through.



01

Beijing 北京

An unparalleled gateway to Chinese civilisation — imperial grandeur that feels planned for you, contemporary energy that just happens. The Forbidden City is the world's largest imperial palace complex; the Great Wall is 43km out of town.

SEE → [Forbidden City](#) [Great Wall](#) [Temple of Heaven](#)



02

Xi'an 西安

Capital of thirteen dynasties, and the eastern end of the Silk Road. The star turn is the Terracotta Army — 8,000+ life-sized warriors buried to guard an emperor. The city walls are still walkable end to end.

SEE → [Terracotta Army](#) [City Wall](#) [Muslim Quarter](#)



03

Shanghai 上海

Asia's most cosmopolitan city — skyscrapers alongside colonial waterfront, upscale dining next to laneway cafés. The Bund's synchronised light show at 7pm still stops people in their tracks.

SEE → [The Bund](#) [Yu Garden](#) [French Concession](#)

Beyond the big three.

The two cities that turn a China trip into something Kiwis quietly rave about back home.



04

Hangzhou 杭州

A landscape aestheticised by human hands for a thousand years — walking the Su Causeway around West Lake at sunrise, before the crowds, is a Chinese poem you get to stand inside.

SEE → [West Lake](#) [Su Causeway](#) [Longjing tea village](#)



05

Chongqing 重庆

A vertical mountain city that stacks streets and skyscrapers across so many levels GPS gives up. The signature draw is a Chongqing hotpot — bolder, more molten mala than Chengdu next door.

SEE → [Hongyadong](#) [Ciqikou old town](#) [Liziba monorail](#)

DEPARTURE 01 · DISCOVERY COLLECTION

Golden China

12 days · Departs Auckland 16 Nov 2026 · Returns 27 Nov 2026 · Beijing · Xi'an · Shanghai

FROM

NZ\$4,999

per person, twin share

GROUP SIZE

Max 12

NZ-only small group

MEALS

26 included

9 B · 7 L · 10 D

HOTELS

4★

Wanda · Mercure ·
Metropark

DAY BY DAY

1. Depart Auckland MU780 22:00
2. Arrive Shanghai · connect Beijing
3. Beijing — Forbidden City · Tiananmen
4. Great Wall (Juyongguan) · hutong pedi-cab & local family
5. Beijing — free exploration
6. High-speed train → Xi'an
7. Terracotta Warriors · Muslim Quarter
8. Fly Xi'an → Shanghai
9. The Bund & Huangpu River evening cruise
10. Zhujiajiao ancient water town
11. Shanghai shopping & leisure
12. Return Auckland

FULLY INCLUDED

- All flights (AKL–Shanghai return + 2 domestic)
- 4★ hotels for 9 nights
- 2nd-class high-speed rail Beijing → Xi'an
- English-speaking guide throughout
- Airport & ground transfers
- All admissions per itinerary

NOT INCLUDED

- Travel insurance · personal expenses
- Tips (suggested NZ\$10 pp/day)

Single supplement **NZ\$690** · Free amendments up to 60 days out · TAANZ-bonded trust account

Full itinerary
→

DEPARTURE 02 · DISCOVERY COLLECTION

Christmas & New Year in China

16 days · Departs **Auckland 22 Dec 2026** · Returns **6 Jan 2027** · Shanghai · Beijing · Xi'an · Chongqing · Guangzhou

FROM NZ\$7,188 per person, twin share	GROUP SIZE Small NZ-only group	MEALS 33 included 12 B · 9 L · 12 D	HOTELS 4★ Metropark · New World · Mercure · Marriott · Elong
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HIGHLIGHTS ACROSS 16 DAYS

1. Christmas Eve at Shanghai's Xintiandi lighting ceremony & Bund German Christmas Market
2. Zhujiajiao water town day trip
3. Sunrise at the Great Wall (Mutianyu section)
4. Forbidden City · Tiananmen · Summer Palace
5. Beijing hutong tour + local family visit
6. Signature Beijing Duck banquet
7. **New Year's Eve at Xi'an Tang Dynasty Ever-Bright City** — performances, float parade
8. Terracotta Warriors · Xi'an City Wall
9. Chongqing 8D magic — Hongyadong · Liziba · Eye in the Clouds
10. Guangzhou yum cha finale

FULLY INCLUDED

- Auckland–Guangzhou return (CZ 306)
- All domestic flights & trains
- 13 nights in 4★ hotels across 5 cities
- English-speaking local guides
- Private airport transfers & sightseeing transport
- All listed admissions incl. NYE event

NOT INCLUDED

- Travel insurance
- Tips (suggested NZ\$10 pp/day)

Single supplement **NZ\$968** · Reserve well ahead — this departure fills earliest

[Full itinerary →](#)

DEPARTURE 03 · DISCOVERY COLLECTION

Christmas & New Year in China

Christchurch

15 days · Departs Christchurch 22 Dec 2026 · Returns 5 Jan 2027 · Direct China Southern CZ618

FROM NZ\$6,188 per person, twin share	SOUTH ISLAND SAVING NZ\$1,000 vs Auckland departure	MEALS 33 included 12 B · 9 L · 12 D	HOTELS 4★ Metropark · New World · Mercure · Marriott
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WHY THE CHRISTCHURCH VERSION

No transfer through Auckland. China Southern resumed the direct Christchurch–Guangzhou route in 2026, and CTS build the same itinerary around it — same Christmas Eve in Shanghai, same sunrise Great Wall, same New Year's Eve at Xi'an Tang Dynasty Ever-Bright City. You save one Guangzhou night (15 days vs 16) and NZ\$1,000 in airfare compared to Auckland.

THE ROUTE

Christchurch → Guangzhou → Shanghai (3n) → Beijing (4n) → Xi'an (3n) → Chongqing (2n) → Guangzhou → Christchurch

FULLY INCLUDED

- CZ618 direct Christchurch–Guangzhou return
- All domestic flights and trains
- 12 nights in 4★ hotels
- English-speaking guides
- Private transfers & sightseeing transport
- All listed admissions incl. NYE event

NOT INCLUDED

- Travel insurance
- Tips (suggested NZ\$10 pp/day)

Single supplement **NZ\$968** · Direct CHC → Guangzhou · no Auckland transfer required

[Full itinerary →](#)

DEPARTURE 04 · DISCOVERY COLLECTION

Best of China

15 days · Departs **Auckland 11 Mar 2027** · Returns **25 Mar 2027** · Beijing · Xi'an · Hangzhou · Shanghai

FROM

NZ\$4,080

per person, twin share

THE EXTRA CITY

Hangzhou

West Lake · tea country

MEALS

22 included

12 B · 9 L · 1 D

HOTELS

4-5★

12 nights across 5 properties

WHAT MAKES THIS ONE DIFFERENT

March in China is spring — cherry blossom starting, West Lake beginning to bloom, cool clear days across the north. This route adds **Hangzhou** to the classic four cities: a West Lake boat tour, a tea ceremony in Meijiawu's Longjing tea village, and the Song-style waterways of Puyuan.

HIGHLIGHTS

1. Temple of Heaven · Forbidden City · Great Wall
2. Beijing hutong pedi-cab & local family visit
3. High-speed rail (G89) → Xi'an
4. Terracotta Warriors · Muslim Quarter
5. Fly Hangzhou · Song-style Puyuan waterways
6. West Lake boat tour · Meijiawu tea ceremony
7. Shanghai — Yuyuan Garden · The Bund · Lujiazui

FULLY INCLUDED

- International + domestic airfares
- 12 nights in 4★ hotels
- 2nd-class high-speed rail (G89) Beijing → Xi'an
- English-speaking guide throughout
- All admissions & sightseeing transport

NOT INCLUDED

- Travel insurance
- Optional acrobatic show / Tang Palace banquet
- Tips (suggested NZ\$10 pp/day)

Single supplement **NZ\$800** · Best value in the 2026-27 catalogue

[Full itinerary →](#)

Four departures, side by side.

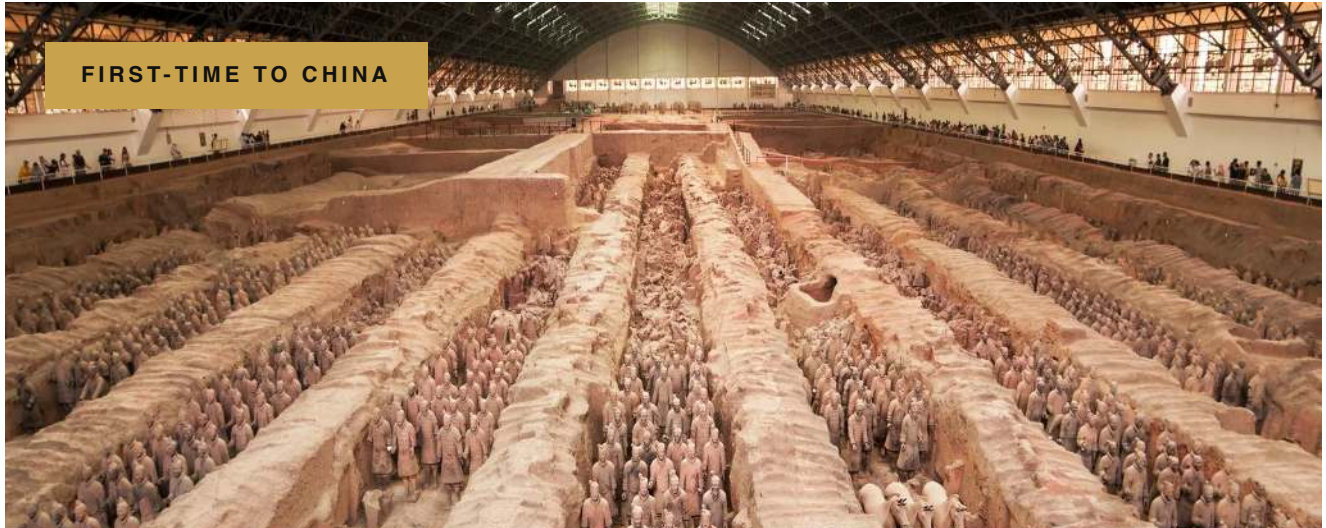
One decision helps most: are you going for late 2026 (Nov / Christmas) or the spring window (March 2027)? Compare in one glance.

	GOLDEN CHINA 12 days · Nov 26	CHRISTMAS AKL 16 days · Dec 26	CHRISTMAS CHC 15 days · Dec 26	BEST OF CHINA 15 days · Mar 27
Departs	Auckland	Auckland	Christchurch (direct)	Auckland
Date	16 Nov 2026	22 Dec 2026	22 Dec 2026	11 Mar 2027
Duration	12 days	16 days	15 days	15 days
Cities	Beijing · Xi'an · Shanghai	+ Chongqing · Guangzhou	+ Chongqing (no AKL transfer)	+ Hangzhou (West Lake)
Meals included	26	33	33	22
Hotels	4★ (9 nights)	4★ (13 nights)	4★ (12 nights)	4★ (12 nights)
Great Wall	Juyongguan	Mutianyu · sunrise	Mutianyu · sunrise	Yes
Season feel	Cool, crisp autumn	Xmas markets · NYE	Xmas markets · NYE	Early spring bloom
From price	NZ\$4,999pp	NZ\$7,188pp	NZ\$6,188pp	NZ\$4,080pp
Single supp.	NZ\$690	NZ\$968	NZ\$968	NZ\$800
Best for	Late-planners · icons in one loop	Full Christmas + NYE experience	Same experience · South Island fare	Best value · adds Hangzhou

NOT SURE? → Reply to any CTS email or call our Auckland office and Baker or the team will walk you through it. We'll ask about timing, group preferences, and any dietary or mobility considerations — then match you to the right departure.

Five things Kiwis get **wrong**.

China moves fast, especially in the cities. A few pointers to sort before you fly.



01

Mobile payment is the default.

Download Alipay or WeChat Pay before you fly — both now support international NZ-issued cards. In the big cities almost every transaction is a QR code. Rural areas and smaller shops still prefer cash, so carry some RMB too.

02

Google won't work. Baidu will.

Google Maps is unreliable inside China. Use Baidu Maps or Gaode Maps for navigation. For menu translation, download Pleco — it works fully offline and reads menus through the camera.

03

Set up a VPN before you leave.

Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp, YouTube and Gmail all face restrictions. Install and test a VPN on your phone before you leave New Zealand — or embrace the digital break for two weeks.

04

Basic Mandarin goes a long way.

Nǐ hǎo (hello), xièxie (thank you), and duōshǎo qián (how much) is 90% of the effort. Locals genuinely appreciate the try, and it turns transactions into small conversations.

05

Tell your bank you're going.

New Zealand card fraud systems can block a first Chinese ATM withdrawal automatically. A quick call to your bank ahead of time avoids getting locked out on Day 1.

Straight through the gate.

30

Days visa-free for NZ passport holders

Valid through 31 December 2026. Tourism, business, family, transit. Unlimited entries. No application forms.

WHAT TO BRING AT IMMIGRATION

- NZ passport with blank pages for stamps
- Return flight (dated within 30 days of entry)
- Proof of accommodation — your CTS tour confirmation is enough
- Sufficient funds (credit cards + some cash)

WHEN YOU STILL NEED A VISA

- Working in China → Z-Visa
- Study or internship → X-Visa
- Staying longer than 30 days → L-Visa
- Long-term residence → consult the Embassy

HOW TO BOOK

Reply to any CTS email

Baker or the CTS team will confirm availability, walk you through the small print, and lock the room within 24 hours. Amendments to dates or travellers are free up to 60 days before departure.

DEPOSIT · NZ\$500 PP TO HOLD

Call the Auckland office

Talk it through with a China specialist — timing, group preferences, any dietary or mobility notes, single-supplement options. All client funds sit in a TAANZ-bonded trust account.

**0800 CTS 888 ·
INFO@CTSTOURS.CO.NZ**



CTS TOURS · AUCKLAND

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